

Activity: How Old Are Reed Faculty?

Please answer the questions on the following pages with your group members.



Modeling Questions

- What explicit features are you analyzing?
- How do you convert these features to numerical estimates?
- How do you resolve differences in opinion among group members?

Definitional Questions

- Is the activity supervised or unsupervised?
- Does it represent a classification or regression problem?
- Are you interested primarily in prediction or inference?
- Are you using parametric or non-parametric methods?

Conceptual Questions

- What are some sources of “error” in your estimates?
- How can we quantify the error in your estimates?
- How should we assess the overall accuracy of a group’s predictions?
- In what other circumstances do people (or companies, or algorithms) predict age based on photos or physical appearance? Is that ethical?